Thermer Google Ads: Weekly Update, Week 2

Reporting period: Nov 3–9, 2026 (changes through Nov 10) · Sent Nov 11, 2026

Summary. Two findings shape the next month. First, raising the target CPA did not buy more installs: two steps (₹2.60 → ₹2.75) added cost per action but no volume, so more growth has to come from new audiences, not higher bids. Second, Google Ads sees only about 1 in 10 real purchases: GA4 records about 50 purchases a day from Google Ads users, Google Ads about 5. On Nov 10 I launched two Bahasa Indonesia ad groups and replaced four weak English assets. My next priority is getting real purchase data into Google Ads.

1. Performance

Campaign “New || Indonesia || In-app action || Targeting”. Google Ads data excludes GST. Recent days are still updating, so First_Print and purchases for Nov 7–9 will rise slightly.

Metric	Oct 27 – Nov 2	Nov 3–9	Change
Spend	₹26,026	₹26,101	0%
Installs per day	1,992	1,928	−3%
Cost per install	₹1.87	₹1.93	+3%
CPC	₹1.38	₹1.45	+5%
First_Print per day (events)	1,291	1,199	−7%
Cost per in-app action	₹2.86	₹3.10	+8%
Purchases in Google Ads	62	32	−48%

GA4, users whose first source is Google Ads (google / cpc):

Metric	Oct 26 – Nov 1	Nov 2–9
New users per day	1,767	1,699
First_Print users ÷ new users	72.3%	74.1%
Purchases per day (in_app_purchase)	53.6	48.6
Purchase revenue per day	₹22,806	₹19,605

- **Volume and cost:** installs dipped 3% and cost per install rose 3%, mainly after the Nov 6 target step and over the weekend (Nov 7–8). Monday Nov 9 recovered to 1,989 installs.
- **Quality held:** in GA4, Google Ads users’ first-print rate rose (72.3% → 74.1%) and purchases dipped only 9%. The 48% purchase drop in Google Ads is a tracking problem (Section 4), not fewer buyers.
- **Against month-1 goals:** installs 1,928/day (goal ≥ 1,900, met). Cost per install ₹1.93 (goal ≤ ₹1.70, not met; see Section 2).

2. Changes this week and what they showed

Date (IST)	Change	Observation → reasoning	Result so far	Decision
Nov 6, 23:52	Target CPA ₹2.70 → ₹2.75	After the Oct 31 step installs were flat; tested whether one more small step would unlock volume	On matching days (Sat–Mon), installs fell 6% (1,901 → 1,780/day) and cost per install rose from ₹1.94 to ₹2.00	Didn’t work. Revert to ₹2.60 on Nov 17 (deferred so the Bahasa launch reads cleanly)

Date (IST)	Change	Observation → reasoning	Result so far	Decision
Nov 7, 00:13	Paused Problem-Solution	Cost per install ₹2.20–2.50, above New (₹1.65–1.81). Its custom-receipt message overlaps New and AI-Oriented	3 days of data, too early. Its 3–4% of spend moved to other ad groups	Keep paused; review Nov 14
Nov 10, 18:22–18:24	4 English assets replaced in New and OCR (below)	The replaced assets were rated Low at ₹2.48–3.15 per install vs ad group averages of ₹1.81 (New) and ₹2.15 (OCR). “Free” and bank-receipt messages have past evidence	Under review	Review Nov 24
Nov 10, 18:32–18:36	New Bahasa ad groups “OCR – ID” and “New – ID”	All ad text was English. In the old campaign, the Bahasa ad group was the cheapest (₹1.63 vs ₹1.73–1.84 for English at the same time). Higher bids added cost, not volume	Under review	Review Nov 17 and Nov 24

Asset swaps on Nov 10:

Ad group	Removed (rated Low)	Added	Why
New	Print Receipts in Seconds (₹2.57)	Free Receipt Printing App	Same headline ran in an older OCR ad group averaging ₹1.68; every local competitor leads with “gratis”
New	Print professional receipts directly from your phone. (₹2.48)	Free to start. Print professional receipts from most Bluetooth thermal printers.	Answers the two pre-install doubts: cost and printer compatibility
OCR	Print Receipts in Seconds (₹3.15)	Print Bank Receipts Faster	Bank and transfer receipt copy cost ~₹1.65 per install in the old campaign; matches money-transfer agents, a primary persona in Confluence
OCR	Snap a receipt photo and reprint it in seconds… (₹3.12)	Free to start. Print transfer receipts quickly on your thermal printer.	Same proven angle, plus “free”

“Free” is used only as “free app” or “free to start”, which matches the product: the first 10 receipts are free, then daily limits apply.

Bahasa ad groups: - **OCR – ID** targets money-transfer agents and reuses the proven copy (e.g. “Cetak Bukti Transaksi Bank”). - **New – ID** targets small businesses with custom receipts (e.g. “Cetak Struk dari HP”, “Gratis, Langsung Cetak”). - Each uses its English twin’s video and 4–5 of its images. The rest were cropped versions that couldn’t be reused. - Expected: 10–20% of spend at ₹1.80 per install or less, and campaign installs above 2,000 a day. - Rollback: pause both if campaign installs fall more than 10% for 3 days running.

Review of last week’s changes (Oct 29–31): - **“Print Fast From Your Phone” (New):** now the best asset in the account, at ₹1.19 per install on ₹3,358 (2,826 installs). Keep. - **The other Oct 31 assets:** most were rated Low after 10 days, so four were replaced on Nov 10. “Receipt photos to printable receipts in seconds.” (Good) stays. - **Target CPA ₹2.60 → ₹2.70:** spend rose 7% with flat installs. Didn’t work; to be reverted (above).

3. Experiments

Experiment	Hypothesis	Spend / sample	Result	Next
Target CPA steps (₹2.60 → ₹2.75)	A higher target unlocks more installs	10 days, ~₹37k	Lost: cost per in-app action ₹2.62 →	Revert to ₹2.60 on Nov 17

Experiment	Hypothesis	Spend / sample	Result	Next
			₹3.26, installs flat to −6%	
English copy refresh (Oct 29–31)	Clearer benefit lines beat Low assets	~₹5k on new assets	Mixed: 1 clear winner, most others Low	Losers replaced Nov 10
Bahasa ad groups	Bahasa reaches users English misses, at equal or lower cost	Started Nov 10	Running	Read Nov 17 / Nov 24
“Free” and bank-receipt assets	These angles beat generic speed claims	Started Nov 10	Running	Read Nov 24
Problem-Solution paused	Its spend works better in other ad groups	3 days	Too early	Review Nov 14

4. Insights

Written in the App Insights format, ready to add to Confluence.

1. Higher target CPA doesn’t buy volume (Bidding · Data-backed · Confidence: High) - Observation: two steps (₹2.60 → ₹2.75) raised cost per in-app action from ₹2.62 to ₹3.26. Installs went flat, then fell 6%. The campaign stayed “Limited by bid strategy” and spent well under budget. - Learning: this campaign tops out at about 2,000 installs a day with its current ads. That matches the founder’s history, where cost per install rose to about ₹2 above ₹4,200/day. More volume needs new audiences or messages, not higher bids.

2. Google Ads sees only about 1 in 10 purchases (Tracking · Data-backed · Confidence: High) - Observation: Oct 22 – Nov 9, Google Ads recorded 132 purchases, most valued at 1. GA4 recorded about 50 purchases a day (in_app_purchase) from Google Ads users. The custom “Purchase” event fires on only about 40–50% of purchases from app version 6.4.8.42 onwards. - Learning: this also explains why the paused “Indonesia Revenue” campaign showed revenue that couldn’t be trusted. The fix needs no new code: import in_app_purchase into Google Ads.

3. Google Ads users are profitable on GA4’s numbers (Revenue · Observation · Confidence: Medium) - Observation: GA4 values a Google Ads user at about ₹19.6 over 120 days (organic ₹21.6), against about ₹2 per install. Google Ads users print at least as often as organic users (72–74% vs 66–68%), and their D1/D7/D30 retention is about the same. - Limitations: gross revenue; some cohorts haven’t reached 120 days. - Learning: quality isn’t the problem. The open question is how many paid installs are truly extra (insight 5).

4. Bahasa ads performed best before, then were dropped (Messaging · Data-backed · Confidence: Medium) - Observation: the Bahasa “OCRIndonesian” ad group was the cheapest in the old campaign (₹1.63 vs ₹1.73–1.84 for English, Jun 2025 – May 2026) and had the most retained users. It wasn’t carried over in the June consolidation. Local competitors all advertise in Bahasa. - Learning: tested again from Nov 10.

5. Some paid installs may replace organic ones (Acquisition · Observation · Confidence: Low–Medium) - Observation: when Google Ads new users fell from about 14k to 11k a week (May–June), organic rose from about 13.5k to 16k. The total stayed about 27k a week. Thermer already ranks #1 on Play for “printer bluetooth”. - Learning: the real return is below the GA4 figure. A controlled spend test is needed before scaling.

6. Editing a winning asset throws away its history (Creative · Data-backed · Confidence: High) - Observation: adding a full stop to “Perfect for shops…” (₹1.59 per install) made it a new asset, now rated Low. - Learning: never edit winners, even punctuation; add a new variant instead.

5. Risks and issues

- **Purchase tracking (action needed):** see insight 2. The developer spec has been shared. The quickest step is importing in_app_purchase (Section 6).
- **New assets under review:** checked on Nov 11. Any disapproval will be reported straight away.
- **Bahasa ad groups have fewer images than their English twins:** 4–5 vs 13–14. Low impact, since images barely serve in this campaign.

- **Saving an app ad removes Google's auto-generated assets:** each edit removed an auto-generated image and an old video (Zf9rXbYPdKI, about ₹47 of spend in 3 months). This looks like a Google side effect; the ad copy wasn't affected.
- **Target CPA at ₹2.75 until Nov 17:** this costs about ₹0.25–0.40 more per in-app action. Kept on purpose for a clean read of the Bahasa launch.

6. Plan for next week (Nov 11–17)

1. **Nov 11:** confirm all new assets are approved and the Bahasa ad groups start delivering.
2. **Import in_app_purchase from GA4 into Google Ads as a Secondary conversion.** This doesn't change bidding. After 7–14 days, if it matches GA4, make it the optimisation event in place of "Purchase".
3. **Nov 14:** review the Problem-Solution pause.
4. **Nov 17:** first read of the Bahasa ad groups and the new assets, and set the target CPA back to ₹2.60.
5. **After Nov 17:** refresh AI-Oriented copy (ad strength Poor; 8 of its 10 assets rated Low).

7. Approvals and information needed

- **Information:**
  - How is the 20% activation goal defined? GA4 shows 72–74% of Google Ads users firing First_Print.
  - What is shown to Google Ads users versus organic users? Your message said ads are shown aggressively to Google Ads users, but Confluence documents no difference.
  - Plan prices in IDR.
- **Developer:** purchase tracking per the spec, and First_Print counted once per user.
- **Approval (month 2):** a controlled spend test to measure how many paid installs are truly extra (see insight 5). I'll send a proposal with the hypothesis, metric, guardrails and maximum spend.

8. Hours

Work	Hours (approx.)
GA4 and Confluence review	2
Evaluating changes and analysis	2
Account changes (Bahasa ad groups, asset swaps)	1.5
Monitoring	1
Purchase tracking spec	1
Reporting and documentation	1.5
Total	**~9** (planned 6–7; extra time went on GA4/Confluence onboarding)